HQ / Brand guidelines

Approved creative identity with production-status labels and practical instructions.

THE MASTER BRAND



Your space. Your system. Your rules.

A calm, premium and precise home for your own tools. One entry point, different purpose-built spaces, with consistent design fundamentals and distinct product identities.

APPROVED: Identity direction, brand architecture, four product symbols, primary colours, typeface choices, latest parent-logo reference.

PENDING: High-quality vector reconstruction of the new parent logo, precise production and accessibility validation.

01 / Brand foundations

What every designer and builder should understand before creating an HQ product.

Purpose

Help people feel in control of their own tools and workflows.

Personality

Minimal, premium, precise, technical, calm.

Emotional outcome

Organised, confident and in control.

Brand promise

A coherent home for distinct, purpose-built digital spaces.

Audience

Eventually anyone wanting their own HQ; current products support individual and team needs.

Five brand principles

- Control by design
- Quiet confidence
- One family, many identities
- Function over decoration
- Freedom within structure

02 / Architecture

The parent brand stays subtle while each product takes centre stage.

Parent brand

HQ is the brand. ownhq.app is the digital address, not the logo name.

Naming

Use [Name] HQ, with spaces: Sport HQ, QED HQ, Work HQ, Personal HQ.

Entry points

Known: qed.ownhq.app and sport.ownhq.app. Work HQ and Personal HQ are future spaces.

Shared UX

A parent portal and an HQ switcher connect spaces. The switcher respects user access permissions.

Product freedom

Products can use different information architectures and tools, but must share typography, visual style and interaction conventions.

03 / Parent HQ logo

Latest integrated H/Q symbol: approved as the brand mark; vector reconstruction pending.

APPROVED USER SOURCE IMAGE / 95 x 97 PX

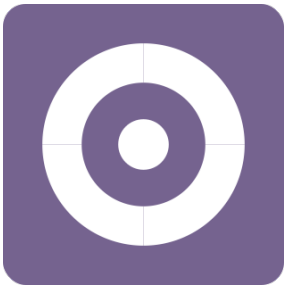


- The latest uploaded integrated H/Q symbol supersedes all earlier Balanced wordmark artwork.
- Primary treatment: charcoal #242424 on a pure white background #FFFFFF.
- Keep it single-colour and proportionally intact; no accent colour, gradients, glow or shadows.
- Use the original raster as the visual approval reference; the SVG trace is provisional.
- Clear space and minimum size remain pending optical verification with the final master.

PRODUCTION WARNING: Do not treat a traced 95px image as finished vector artwork. Curves, stem alignment and small-size fidelity must be rebuilt and approved.

04 / Product symbols

Four approved abstract concepts share a solid square, white forms and muted accent colours.



Sport HQ

Movement / rhythm / consistency

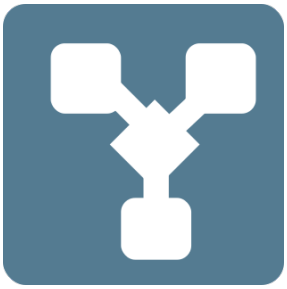
#75638F / APPROVED



Work HQ

Structure / progress / organisation

#486B94 / APPROVED



QED HQ

Connection / coordination / shared resources

#547B91 / APPROVED



Personal HQ

Individuality / ownership / personal centre

#9F597A / APPROVED

Symbol geometries are approved as concepts. Production requires equal optical size, 16px testing and particular attention to the QED hub junction.

05 / Colour system

Primary accents approved; tints, neutrals and dark-mode colours remain proposed pending QA.

Sport HQ

PRIMARY #75638F

LIGHT #F1EDF5

DARK #594771

Work HQ

PRIMARY #486B94

LIGHT #EBF0F6

DARK #345173

QED HQ

PRIMARY #547B91

LIGHT #EBF2F5

DARK #3B6075

Personal HQ

PRIMARY #9F597A

LIGHT #F7EDF1

DARK #793E5D

Shared light neutrals / proposed

canvas	surface	subtle	border	primaryText	secondaryTex
#FAFAF9	#FFFFFF	#F2F2F0	#E5E5E3	#242424	#666666

Rule: Use product accents on important actions, active states and limited highlights. Keep most surfaces neutral. Validate all actual contrast and interaction states.

06 / Typography & layout

Geist Sans is the primary UI face. Geist Mono is only for genuinely technical fixed-width data.

Typography

Geist Sans for headings, body, cards, navigation, buttons and ordinary metrics. Geist Mono for logs, structured identifiers and code.

Suggested type scale

Desktop / mobile: page title 36 / 28px; section 24 / 22px; card 18 / 18px; body 16 / 16px; compact UI 14 / 14px; metadata 12 / 12px.

Weight and rhythm

Regular 400, medium 500, semibold 600; 700 reserved for strong emphasis. Heading line-height 1.25; body 1.5.

Layout

Shared top navigation; balanced density; mixture of dividers, flat content and restrained cards.

Components

Proposed 8px radius, 4px base spacing, coloured primary actions and neutral secondary actions. Mobile and desktop have equal priority.

Motion and access

Subtle 150-200ms transitions, prefers-reduced-motion support, clear keyboard focus and accessible targets.

07 / Logo use & mistakes

Logo and interface rules that prevent visual fragmentation.

DO

- Use the new integrated H/Q mark for the parent brand only.
- Preserve shape, white background and neutral black tone.
- Use distinct white abstract symbols on product colour squares.
- Keep primary actions in product colour, most surfaces neutral.
- Keep labels short, clear and recognisable.

DO NOT

- Reintroduce the old 01 Balanced logo.
- Recolour the HQ parent logo purple, blue or raspberry.
- Stretch logos, add gradient fills or drop shadows.
- Put every card and border in accent colour.
- Build brand marks from generic UI icons or use casual motivational microcopy.

08 / Voice & examples

Useful interface copy is direct and free of exaggerated enthusiasm.

PREFER	AVOID
Add session	Let's crush your workout!
Activity saved	You're absolutely smashing it!
No tasks yet	Your productivity journey begins here
Open workspace	Unlock your ultimate productivity
Something went wrong. Try again.	Oopsie! A tiny snag!

Example context

- Sport HQ: planner, activity log, races, shoes, body and goals.
- QED HQ: internal tools, team links and onboarding.
- Work HQ and Personal HQ: planned identities, not published functional claims.

09 / Production handoff

The source of truth, what's safe to use now, and what requires final designer QA.

APPROVED / Creative

Brand strategy, naming, parent logo appearance, four abstract product concepts, four primary muted accent colours, Geist Sans and selective Geist Mono, top-nav architecture and voice.

PROVISIONAL / Technical

Raster-to-SVG parent trace, logo clear space, final logo small-size variants, support shades, light/dark neutral palette, exact type/spacing/radius sizes, interaction states and UI samples.

DELIVERABLES

PDF + Markdown guidelines; original parent reference; provisional parent SVG; product SVG/PNG exports; CSS/JSON tokens; accessible-colour calculation CSV; HTML UI sample; QA checklists.

NEXT ACTIONS

Redraw parent vector and sign off. Validate the four product marks at small sizes. Verify WCAG states and mobile behaviour. Validate legal/trademark availability before external launch.